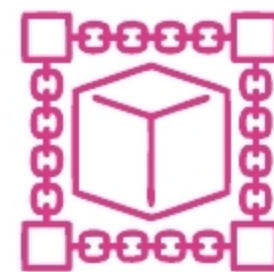


Getting Started *with* Blockchain



Transparency, immutability and security, which characterise blockchain technology, have propelled it into unthought of domains. From being a means of carrying out decentralised monetary or asset transactions, it has now been adopted in areas like healthcare, real estate, supply chain management and energy distribution.



Blockchain is a peer-to-peer ledger system that allows transactions among peers without any centralised authority. The peer-to-peer network is completely decentralised because each peer carries a copy of the ledger. The ledger can be a complete copy or the minimal copy required for it to stay connected and functional for the network.

To ensure consensus across transactions, consensus methods like proof-of-work, proof-of-stake, etc, are used. Also, each transaction is completely secured with the help of advanced cryptographic algorithms. Clearly, the whole blockchain mechanism is used to benefit from its trust, immutability and transparency. The idea is the complete opposite of centralisation. In short, it is a network

with peers capable of doing transactions without any centralised authority. This simple idea is single-handedly changing how industries work.

Healthcare, for example, can now be revolutionised to store patients' data on the blockchain. In this way, patients do not have to carry their own documents as everything is stored on the network,

